



PHOTOS BY **MANDAR DEODHAR**

out of India's nearly 350 million households, are investing in the markets.

SZ: How much of a role has technology and ease of use played in the rise of the equity cult?

AC: For me, technology is everything. All change that happens is primarily due to technology. And the stock markets in India have played a pivotal role in ushering in information technology into the country.

In the early '90s, when NSE was conceptualised, there weren't many computers in India. Getting a telephone line used to take five years and keeping it working was a bigger challenge.

At that time, our policymakers visualised an exchange that would be completely automated, with screen-based trading, a concept that didn't exist globally. The NASDAQ was essentially a quote screen, you had to call someone to place a trade. There was no screen-based order matching.

“The stock markets in India have played a pivotal role in ushering in information technology into the country”

India's policymakers decided to set up an automated exchange. I was part of the implementation team, and we wondered how we'd do it without basic infrastructure like telephone lines. That's when we decided to use satellites, and the rest is history.

With the setting up of NSE in 1994, information technology slowly began seeping into India. NSE was